

ECON311

Critical Review

Name: Jaime Petersen

Topic: Review of “The COVID crisis and productivity growth”

Introduction:

3.5/5

- Your introduction is mixing the short-run effect of policies introduced by the government during the pandemic with the long-run effect of Covid-19, including the long-run effect of these policies. The article uses a growth accounting framework to study the **long-run** effect of the pandemic, in particular, its long-run effect on measured productivity

Critical Economic Analysis:

21.5/30

- **Labour:** As in the introduction, there must be a clearer distinction between the immediate effect of the pandemic and its long-run implications for economic growth. Also, it is not clear to me, from your discussion, why remote work would increase labour productivity in the short run. The authors’ argument is centered around the long-run implications of the pandemic on human capital accumulation.
- **Capital:**
- **TFP:** Again, your focus is mainly on the short run. Also, your discussion mixes short-run disruptions to production due to supply and demand forces with changes in productivity, defined as the amount of output produced by a given number of inputs. For instance, it is not clear how restrictions to the number of workers would lead to a decrease in productivity rather than a reduction in output produced.
 - *Within-Firm:* Your discussion of this topic is mostly about short-run transitions and not about long-run effects of the pandemic on firm productivity.
 - *Across-Firm:* Your critical review includes an adequate discussion of this topic.
 - *Across-Sectors:* Your discussion of this topic is not clear. You mention an increase in the production of PPE, but you do not argue why the PPE sector is either more or less productive than other sectors. Also, this is a short-run effect of the pandemic.

Exposition:

7/10

- The paper is, for the most part, well organized
- However, there are paragraphs that are too long and should have been edited for clarity. Also, there was some repetition of ideas, which resulted in important concepts from the article being excluded.
- References are properly cited

Conclusion:

3.5/5

- The conclusion needs to be expanded to properly summarize the content of your review.

Grade: 35.5/50 = 71%